**An Overview of the Colby-Park Tenant Union (or CPTU) Meeting on October 28, 2026**

## Scheduling

Thanksgiving in November has disrupted the normal pattern of a general meeting on the last Wednesday of the month, giving CPTU just three weeks to prepare for the next steps. CPTU developed the following schedule to meet the needs of the union:

- Planning team meeting agendas:
    - Nov. 4: Schedule several canvassing actions, edit and finalize the demand letter.
    - Nov. 11: Develop a battle plan for the demand letter, plan the general meeting agenda
- Canvassing Team:
    - Nov 2: Meet outside Parkwin (1190 Park Ave) at 6 PM.
- Rent Stabilization
    - Nov. 3: Meet at 10 Manhattan Square Dr, Rochester, NY 14607 at 5:30 PM.

## The Parkwin Building

The Parkwin building at 1190 Park Ave--which shares a common landlord with us--is organizing its first tenant union membership card drive and needs volunteers.

- We will meet outside Parkwin at 6 PM on Monday, November 22nd.
- We will also be knocking several doors in Colby-Park in an effort to push our union beyond its current representation of 51.5% of occupied units.
    - Those who were previously hesitant to accept membership in CPTU will be visited by a different member than last time.
    - While some card-holding members are moving out, some who have not signed cards are also being replaced, giving CPTU constant opportunities.

## Demand Letter

CPTU's demand letter was reviewed.

- A tenant union demand letter is the collective goals of the union put into writing for the landlord to review.
- The current, and unfinished DRAFT of the CPTU demand letter is available here.
- CPTU authorized the planning team to edit and finalize the demand letter, provided the following is accomplished:
    - Shrinking the letter
    - Adding a section for accessibility upgrades.

    - Specifically mentioning electrical outlets to further justify widespread electrical upgrades.
    - Developing a delivery method for a bad or good faith reception

## Volunteerism

Volunteerism within CPTU was promoted. The following dates present opportunities for everyone:

- The canvassing team will be meeting outside Parkwin at 6 pm on Monday, November 2nd.
    - The canvassing team knocks doors to recruit new members into the union(s).
- The planning team will be meeting the **first** and **second** Wednesday of November.
    - Typically, these meetings are held the first and third Wednesday of the month, however, Thanksgiving has affected scheduling.
- The rent stabilization team for the City Wide Tenant Union of Rochester is meeting on Tuesday November 3rd at 5:30 PM at 10 Manhattan Square Dr, Rochester, NY 14607.
    - Please reach out if you need a ride.

## Communication Methods

The CPTU decided to move towards mass emails as a primary communication method for the general union, replacing the current group text.

- A free website will be produced to mirror email content or host important files, allowing the canvassing team to share materials with prospective members.
- Teams (planning, canvassing, *etc.*) will continue to use group text messages as a primary communication method.

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**The agenda is presented below for reference.**

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# COLBY PARK TENANT UNION MEETING AGENDA

# October 28, 2026:

- Roles for the meeting (5 min or less)
    - Stack system needs to be reviewed.
- Introductions (5 min or less)
- News items (10 mins)

    - Valleybrook story (5 mins)
    - Park Win update (5 mins)
- The demand letter (30 - 45 mins)
    - Read and discuss the demand letter (20 mins)
        - Is an important issue not addressed or are they addressed improperly?
        - Are there problems with the wording/meaning/structure of the demand letter?
    - Approve/Improve/Rewrite the demand letter (5 - 10 mins)
        - If approved, determine next steps and preparation plans (15 mins)
            - Preparation plan for good faith scenario.
            - Preparation plan for bad faith scenario.
- Recruiting and organizing volunteers and leaders (15 min)
    - Canvassing team, planning team, rent stabilization
- Communication methods (5 mins)
- Open Discussion (5 mins)
- Debrief (5 mins)
- Next Meeting Dates (5 mins):
    - General Meeting: November 18 @ 6 pm (the third Wednesday of the month).
    - Planning Meeting (1st and 2nd Wednesday of the month)
    - Next Rent Stabilization Meeting date November 3rd, 2026